ALERT

Antyodaya- An initiative for empowering the Adivasis in Andhra Pradesh

Annual report 01st April 2020 to 31st March 2021

ALERT is a Non-governmental, Not for profit organization that was established in 2004 bearing the Registration No.307/2004. Since 2004, the organization has been working in partnership with local communities on rights and entitlements, sustainable livelihood, participatory governance etc. Since September 2018, with the support of BFTW, Antyodaya Project is being implemented for the empowerment of Indigenous communities. The Antyodaya project has commenced working in the scheduled areas of East and West Godavari districts, where in several thousand of Adivasis are subjected to forced displacement due to the construction of the Polavaram National Irrigation Project, which is seen as the largest Adivasis displacement project in India. The ongoing program of anthyodaya pilot phase commenced in September -2018.

Vision of ALERT: "Transforming the Lives of excluded communities for Prosperity and Peace"

Mission of ALERT: "To awaken, educate, organize and mobilize the Adivasi communities for Self-governance, Self-reliance, Sustainable environment and development".

Shared Values of ALERT: ALERT has well-defined shared values which are meticulously followed up. Those are

- Commitment for the cause.
- Accountability
- Integrity
- Transparency
- Gender justice
- Professional excellence
- Empathy with the socially excluded and marginalized
- Connectivity for building relations and Results management

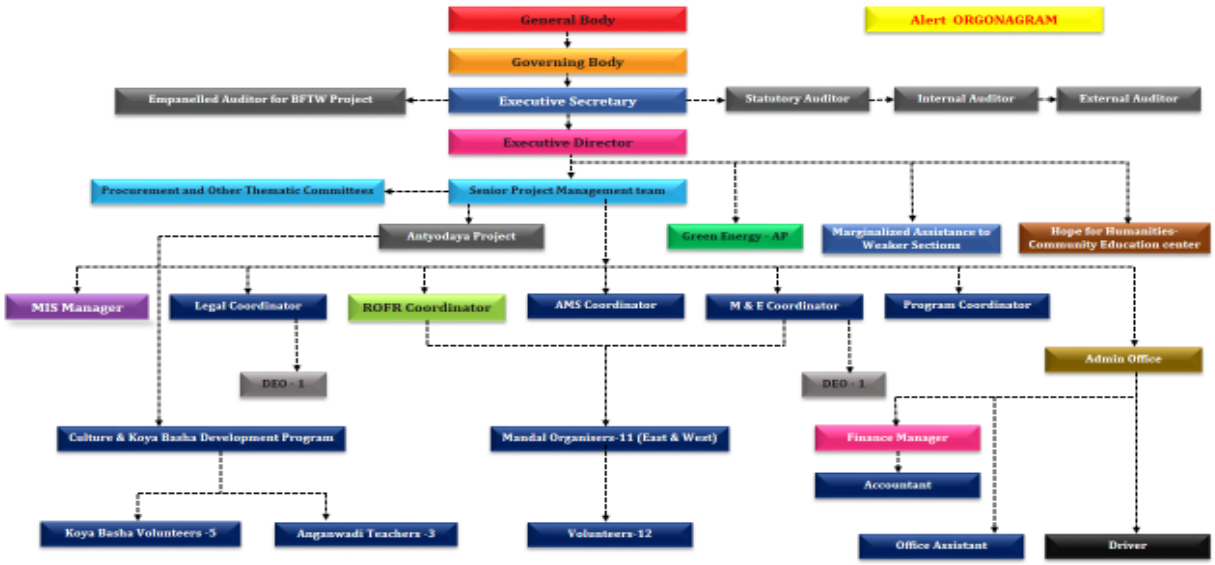
The Alert is governed based on the following Policies:

- Gender Policy
- Humans Resources Policy
- Purchase / Procurement Policy
- Conflict of interest policy
- HIV / AIDS Policy
- Environmental Policy
- Social Inclusion Policy
- Common Cost Policy,

- Do not Harm Policy
- Empowerment Adivasis policy,
- Environmental policy
- Finance Manual
- HR Manual

The Governance in ALERT:

There are seven highly qualified members in the Governing body of ALERT with considerable experience in NGO Sector. The governing body meets once in three months to review the organizational work, the performance ongoing work, advice the Executive Secretary as well as to have over sight of organizational and project management staff. The Executive Secretary will be responsible for legal compliances, good governance, accountability to all stake holders besides for the mobilization of resources, communication with key stake holders, steering advocacy, lobbying on project, submission of annual reports and organization related matters.



Management Team:

Project Management consists of Executive-Secretary, Finance Manager, MIS Manager, Five Thematic coordinators, and thirteen mandal coordinators, several CBOs, Volunteers & leaders of FPOs. A few

thematic organizations have also emerged as partners in managing the projects as well as the process in creating impact and contribute in the sustainable development of Adivasi communities.

The Key Objectives of ALERT are:

- To Empower Adivasis in self-governance, self-reliance and sustainable development of community-based organizations.
- To promote gender justice, equality and address the issues of gender discrimination, economic advancement through women-owned and managed organizations.
- To facilitate effective service delivery in availing rights, entitlements and Government schemes for improving their living standards, contributing to the sustainable development of socially excluded and marginalized communities
- To promote and support sustainable environmental measures with special focus on Mangroves, shelter belts, food forest, agro forestry , regeneration of agriculture and other NRM interventions for creating sustainable livelihoods and sustainable developments
- To initiate livelihood support through land mobilization, land development, sustainable agriculture for addressing food and nutrition security, promotion of FPOs and Co-operatives for the economic advancement of Adivasis.
- To promote, support for strengthening the resilience of survivors of natural and human-induced disasters.
- To promote & support food forest, agro forestry and value added services, green energy etc.
- To Promote and protect of child rights and happy child hood and wellbeing of mothers & children's
- To provide counselling, career need based guidance, skill development for gainful employment of youth and women.
- To promote innovative and sustainable agriculture and aqua practices and allied activities for improving the living standards of tribal communities
- To render support services for the society excluded communities for mainstreaming and wellbeing

Financial & Technical Partners:

Bread for the World, Hope for Humanity, Green energy AP, CMFRI, KVKs, Fisheries Welfare Institute, Tribal welfare department, I.T.D.A's of ASR & K.R puram, NABARD, R&R Commissioner, Department of Fisheries, Andhra Pradesh, and Andhra Loyola College.

Area of Operation:

Spread over in 16 mandals spread over in the Scheduled areas of East and West Godavari districts of A P that include 8 mandals affected by Polavaram Irrigation Project and six coastal mandals of Krishna District

Target Area & Target Groups:

The Project affected families' from three ITDAs will benefit from ALERT's macro level interventions and they will be positively and indirectly impacted. Further, the R&R line departments, the Project affected families from other parts of the AP where land acquisition and displacement process is ongoing, may also benefit from the experiences of ALERT. **The NGOs working on Adivasi rights & welfare issues may derive benefits from the diversified experiences of ALERT.**
The key stakeholders like Fisheries Department, Tribal Welfare Department and Revenue Departments are apprised of issues and strategies for addressing the issues of Adivasis in total 16 mandals of Alert. The Advocacy groups, networks, alliances working on RoFR, Adivasis, R&R issues and researchers as well as media personnel focusing on RoFR, Development induced displacements, human right bodies are also be positively impacted with the interventions, documentation and dissemination of information as well as experience. Alert intensively works for 8 Submergence mandals as follows, of which 5 mandals (Devipatnam, VR Puram, Polavaram, Kukunoor and Velairpadu) will be intensive interventions. These are divided into two categories 5 mandals under intensive interventions, 2 mandals namely Jeelugumilli, Buttayigudem , where majority of housing colonies come up and those areas, that witnessed several LTR violations and subjected to more exploitation by non-tribes. Those 2 mandals were also taken up under intensive area of operation.The Scheduled areas of East & West Godavari Districts covering three ITDAs 70452 tribal households in 1337 habitations of 16 mandals having 320792 population (155397 male and 165395 female). The Polavaram Project Affected Adivasi families living in 371 habitations are also primary stakeholder consisting of 63,629 ST& SC families. In Krishna District there are 6 Coastal mandals where in Alert works with 1503 Yenadi tribal families, SC's and Fisher folk living in 90 villages.

Major Achievements in 1st April 2020 to 31st March 2021:

Indicator-1

Objective: At least 20,000 grievances successfully resolved in availing of rights, entitlements and subsidized schemes.

Sl.No	*Details*	*Petitions/ Grievances*
	March-2020 to August-2020	
1	Carried forward Petitions/ Grievances from previous reporting period	24117
2	Petitions/ Grievances filed during this Reporting period	55803
	Total Petitions filed	**79920**
3	Petitions/ Grievances resolved during this reporting period	25330
4	Petitions/ Grievances in process	54590
	Cumulative data (August-2020 to 28th Februvary-2021)	
5	Petitions/ Grievances filed	139911
6	Petitions/ Grievances Resolved	85321
7	Petitions/ Grievances in process	54590

Indicator-2

Objective: Realization of at least 6 out of 9 R&R packages by Polavaram project affected families in all relocated Adivasi Habitations.

No.of Habitations	No.of Colonies	Total PDFs	1. 5 cents of House site /275 square feet house			2. Land for Land			3 Annuity			4. Subsistance, Transportation andon time resettlement		
			Eligible	Availed		Eligible	Availed		Eligible	Availed		Eligible	Availed	
67	**42**	**8458**	**8458**	**8232**	**97%**	**2370**	**2330**	**98%**	**8458**	**7940**	**94%**	**8458**	**7889**	**93%**

5. Cattle shed/ Pettyshop			6. Artisan, small traders			7 Fishing Rights			8. Value of assets attached			9. Others (to get entitlements as per Applicable New land Acquisition Act 2013)	
Eligible	Availed		Eligible	Availed		Eligible	Availed		Eligible	Availed		Eligible	Availed
789	**599**	**76%**	**48**	**48**	**100%**	**1411**	**0**	**0%**	**8458**	**8341**	**99%**	**814**	**0**

Out of 9 parameters in 7 parameters, the target value achieved ranged from 76 % to cent percent, where as in two parameters, there was zero achievement. But, lot of process documentations was done to avail those rights and entitlements.

Indicator-3

Project Objective: at-least 20000 acres of individual /community lands availed (most of the assetsare either jointly or individually owned by women).

Sl. No	ITDA	REAPPLICATION OF REJECTED ANDNEW APPLICATIONS		APPROVED		PENDING		REJECTED	
		No.of Claims	Extent Acres	No.of Claims	Extent Acres	No.of Claims	Extent Acres	Total Claims	Total Extent Acres
1	RCVARAM	17241	115151.5	12296	83546	4529	30437.50	416	1168
2	KRPURAM	21490	52741.10	842	13715	1527	5777.10	19121	29362
3	CHINTURU	10018	31599	2315	6136	560	5294	7301	24056
TOTAL		48749	199491.6	15453	103397	6537	41508.6	26838	58473

- Alert Society under took relief measures with the support of BftW 3300 solar powered lights @ 7.92 Lakhs, House repair support for 63 families with the grant of 1.89 Lakhs, and 4 motorized fibre boats fitted with 10 HP engines @ 3.90 Lakhs to the flood affected victims in East and West Godavari Districts.
- Alert Society has distributed relief materials with Grocery items to 2650 families for 7.95 Lakhs in West Godavari, 2 bed sheets for 2300 families @ 6.90 Lakhs and two motorized boats fitted with 10 HP diesel engines @ 3.72 Lakhs to flood affected victims in East Godavari district.
- Promotion of cage culture grow out ponds sustainable aqua farming introduction cost effective quality fish feed (Floating+ sinking) nurseries value addition direct market for ensuring the sustainable livelihood of SCs , STs and fishers folk with women as the major stakeholders of all Alerts interventions.

Major Activities under taken:

- Facilitating and supporting for improving the productivity, production, value addition and facilitate / support direct marketing by eliminating middle men for sustainable economic advancement of small and marginal farmers and aqua pruners in envisaged.
- Promotion of the Green Energy solutions in the scheduled areas of East & West Godavari areas.
- Organizing and undertaking of relief measures, R&R, programs, under PNIP ,building the resilience and promote districts of sustainable development of primary stake holders affected by natural calamities and human induced disasters in the seven submergence mandals under Polavaram Project Institution.
- Partnering with National as well as International likeminded NGOs, Central and State Government in facilitating effective service delivery for the all-round development of socially, economically and culturally disadvantaged people
- Taking up intensified interventions in availing forest & land rights, land development, diversified, innovative agricultural and aquaculture practices for enhancing production, value addition assured income and decent living standards
- Ensuring women's effective participation and create equal opportunities for women lead leadership at all levels towards gender equality, gender justice and empowerment of Women
- Assisting in effectively make use of real time governance mechanisms, appropriate adaptive information and communication technologies for empowering unemployed youth, women and the poorest poor of the society.
- During the reporting period 136 RTIs were filed on 53 types of issues information were collected on 48 RTI applications and 88 are pending at different levels. Now people are making use of provisions of RTI, though the response is limited which requires further follow-up.
- On R&R issues, an awareness programme was conducted on 19-06-2020 at Polavaram office and 143 members (46 women and 97 men) participated from 35 villages and resolved to follow- up in coordination with various CBOs'. The secondary data is regularly collected from R&R colonies and follow-up measures under taken in monitoring the implementation of R&R packages. The surviours of Polavaram Project are organized on a regularly basis to represent their issues with the special officers who are responsible for implementing rehabilitation work. More than 10000 compliance were filed with the special collector of Polavaram Project in addition the people come together to take up resistance programs whenever threatened of eviction are when the official are visited their villages. Regular representations are made by the villagers and also formal and informal representations with the special officers appointed for implementing RR packages but without much results. On 01-03-2020 at Kukkunuru village 147 members (69 women and 78 men) participated in a training program on land laws and related issues and on R&R packages. On 03-

07-2020 at Polavaram, 116 members participated (29 women and 87 men) in training program on land laws, PESA and R&R packages. More appropriate and updated resource materials on Forest rights and R&R issues were collected through outsource support. Key data was also availed and shared with staff and they are kept posted of the key information needed for their day to day interventions and undertaken capacity building activities where ever found necessary. Adivasi Maha Sabha as petitioner file cases with Lokayukta which has issued 26 notices to people like Collector of EG District, R & R Commissioner etc on issues concerning RoFR and R&R packages involving Devipatnam mandal and other submergence villages and cases are being pursued.

- Capacity building training was conducted in Cage Culture on 06-03-2020 at Bhavadevarapalli, 50 participated (19 women and 31 men) on 07-03-2020 at Pedapalem village where new cages are proposed to be installed for SCs and STs under sub plan and another training was conducted for 70 members (31 women and 39 men)

- The IEC materials are regularly disseminated conducting of focused group discussions and administering of formats for collecting the data, collecting the grievances and facilitating their filing and their direct representation is one of the regular activity of organizer and coordinators.

- Regular interventions are taken up with Adivasi fisher communities in the neighborhood of four reservoirs. The effective usage of boats in Godavari River is also taken up by the local fisher group in coordination with the respective District Adivasi Maha Sabhas.

- Every month, two review meetings for staff on 15th and 30th are conducted in the field offices. The work done report is reviewed subsequent fortnight plans are discussed. Further, travel as well as food related reports etc. are collected and posted to Vijayawada office for payments and follow up. Project performance review meetings were held at 3 ITDAs'. All organizers and concerned thematic coordinators participated in those meetings to review the progress made in 6 months and finalized action plan for the next six months at Alerts' office. The Executive Director, Legal Coordinators and other thematic coordinators regularly attend the meetings concerning the project related matters. In future, there will be more such interventions as a follow up RTI related invitations to examine the documents, legal representations at District and State level meetings. An interface meeting was held at Rampachodavaram ITDA on 16th June, 2020, Project Officer (CEO) '11 staff and several community leaders attended.

Project Objective:

1. Important changes (social, political, economic and ecological) in the projects immediate environment since its inceptions.

a) Lockdown announcement for over 3 months due to Covid-19 pandemic from March 23rd, affected routine work in Government offices and in the implementation of RoFR, R & R packages, conduct of regular grievances redressals meetings etc. in the binging of the project.

b) The elections scheduled for March & April to the local bodies were postponed which affected the capacitation programs scheduled to be conducted for elected representatives in the scheduled areas.

c) Unprecedented floods in the catchments areas of Polavaram project is becoming an annual feature, which affect the work in the submergence villages.

d) The Government of India should finance the construction of the Polavaram Project that include R&R packages. Out of Rs. 55,000 crore estimated Rs. 33,000 crore rupees in meant only for R & R packages. It is reluctant to pay the arrears and honor the commitments made earlier as a part of AP Re- Organization Act. Hence, there is considerable delay in the construction of Polavaram dam and in relocating the displaced families. This problem might continue for a few more years.

e) Most of the websites concerning RoFR, R & R, Grievances redressals, other key subjects like Giri Bhoomi etc. are blocked and not accessible to the public. Those are also defunct. This affected the regular updating of MIS date from the secondary source, hence provisions of R.T.I was involved to collect the data and take up concerted actions including the legal interventions. This process to be intensified till results are achieved.

f) The Government of India enacted three Acts concerning Farmers, which are being vehemently opposed by the farmers and opposition parties, because they are of the view that the newly enacted Farmer Acts are favoring the corporate sector, which contribute to further exploitation and marginalization of debt ridden farmers.

2. Changes having implications for the work, the project objective and the latter's achievement

The delay in implementing the R & R packages due to non-fulfilment of commitments by the Government of India, inadequate budget allocations by the State Government of AP, under estimating the budgetary provisions for implementing the R & R packages, will adversely affect the implementation of R & R packages and exclusion of encroached government lands, pending claims of RoFR, D-form patta lands, community lands falling in the submergence areas which will involve the major junk of the budget meant for the Re-habitation and resettlement project.

At present the State Government is indulging in manipulative and coercive measure to evict the Polavaram project affected families , which calls for documenting the facts, creating awareness and mobilizing the survivors of the project affected families by taking course to seeking justice and other support as well as solidarity measures till the just demands of survivors materialized.

3. Project performance review of Achievement of objectively verifiable indicators.

The organizers and coordinators facilitate and assist the villagers in filing petitions and representing them at their Mandal level. The grievances are also taken up through Spandana help lines. The Coordinators

and organizers also collecting the details of grievances received in various departments and following them up. During the reporting period 55803 (that include RoFR applications) new petitions were filed and pending petitions were also followed up.

4. Activities under taken:

5.1 Changes observed relevance to the project progress.

- People when provided with data on rejected claims and the overlooked, and denied rights, entitlements, respond promptly but the induced enthusiasm has to be sustained with regular follow ups or through self-motivated leaders and volunteers. Social media groups for different regions and themes are contemplated to be introduced.
- The government officials responsible for addressing rights and entitlements and other forms of service delivery are coming under immense pressure but this pressure is to be accelerated till the results are achieved, effective follow ups to be ensured on all issues of concern.
- The information that must be kept at the disposal of the Gramasabhas and for public view, are either hidden or destroyed. This must be followed up so that the required information is made available to the local Adivasi communities for concerted actions and follow tips.
- There is visible improvement in the cooperation of three major departments viz Tribal Welfare Department, Forest and Revenue due to pressure for completing field verifications on FR claims, which resulted in clearing and issuing of title deeds to a large extent in RC Varam ITDA, where as in K.R Puram and Chinturu ITDAs' more effective lobbying and litigation measures have to be undertaken for clearing the pending and rejected claims.

5.2 Negative outcome of the project

ALERT maintains cordial working relationship with key government line departments viz Tribal Welfare, Fisheries & ITDA. However, one major problem is, the Adivasi Maha sabha is being targeted by the police and intelligence department by projecting its interventions as law and order problems, which has been clarified through formal and informal dialogue and representations.

5.3 The issues and concerns contributing to or interfering with the accomplishment of the development goal.

- Inadequate awareness, influence of vested interests in all 3 major departments viz Forest, Revenue and Tribal welfare as well as the demotivated, misadventures Adivasi leadership which are seen as major impediments in implementing a just R & R packages a challenging task. More ground work of motivating, mobilizing as well as organizing of primary stake holders, collecting and building supporting documents, evidences are pre-requisite followed by consistent results centric interventions.

- Joint field visits with officials and community leaders, focused group discussions, roping in Adivasi caste based organizations with need based support services and sharing of information, enlisting their cooperation under the umbrella of Joint Action Committees and sharing all relevant information from habitation to mandal levels help in speeding up of the work with shared responsibilities and ownership.
- Further, exchanging of information, sharing of experience, providing platform for the visibility, rapport building with key resource persons and subject experts of the area is seen as an added advantage.
- The realignment of organizations with the open agenda of creating win-win situation with non-invasive attitude and approach may ensure more involvement of chief functionaries of local CSOs, caste based organizations, opinion leaders etc.
- The core strategy of intervention in the target areas is to keep ALERT at low profile and promoting as well as supporting the Adivasi communities under the banner of Adivasi Maha Sabha and Polavaram Irrigation project affected People's Rights Collective in creating mass awareness, dissemination of information extensively on RoFR, grievances redressals and R & R issues. Encouraging Adivasi Maha Sabha and Polavaram project survivors collective in partnering with CBOs and NGOs for the cause of Adivasis wellbeing creates a space for Adivasi leaders in their identity, visibility, recognition and establish them as local Adivasi leaders and perhaps as elected representatives of local bodies (rescheduled elections to local bodies due shortly) so that the concept of self-governance in the scheduled areas are practically experimented.
- Delay in the execution of Supreme Court's directives after staying its own orders in Feb, 2019, has given more time and space to get prepared to argue for the cause of Adivasis in availing Forest Rights and ALERT is appraised of the situation. The state government with funds crunch to take up developmental activities started fixing targets for distributing the title deeds and this is an unintended positive gesture helped in getting several thousand title deeds for the forest lands that are being cultivated for several decades without formal ownership deeds.
- Delay in the execution of Polavaram Irrigation Project and in the implementation of R&R packages gives sufficient time to equip Alert and AMS in finalizing the data on all forms of violations in implementing R&R packages and Forest Right on which Alert and AMS decided to focus during the next one year through lobbying, advocating, litigating and building public pressure.

5.4 The methods and tools applied to assess the project's outcome and impact

- The minutes of monthly and half yearly as well as reports of issue based meetings.
- Validation and updating of the indicators centric monitoring data analysis and steering up of follow up measures.
- Comparison of ALERT's MIS data with official records of 3 ITDAs, Tribal Welfare departments, special officer of R & R office, R & R Commissionerate, State office of RoFR, and affiliated units

and those are effectively used in the implementation monitoring and assessing the outcome of the project measures with special focus on three indicators.

- The rejected claims on RoFR with reasons were examined and found that most of them are against the provisions of FR Act. Hence, the details were shared at habitation level and with the chair persons of SDLC and DLC and they were made to re-examine the rejected claims and consider new claims and the published approved list of title holders reveal the effectiveness of our interventions.
- Focused group discussions on outcome assessment related issues are conducted on a regular basis.
- Administration of interview schedule for collecting data from R & R colonies, Adivasi habitations and findings are being effectively used for strategic interventions and monitoring the outcome measures.
- The data uploaded in Giri Bhoomi websites on all RoFR title deeds holders, whereas the ongoing process is yet to be completed which requires regular updates.
- Presentation of Government reports to the monitoring institutes of Government of India like PPA, MoTA, Central Water Commission, ST commission, State Level Monitoring Committee reveal the outcome of our work where Alert works and performance could be compared with non-operational areas of ALERT.
- Reports appearing in social media, print & electronic media are also some other methods we apply to assess the outcome of the project.

6. Way forward

ALERT / AMS has to take up to interventions in a campaign mode and to illiterate:

- Habitation Rights for PVTG habitation (Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups).
- Antyodaya Ration Cards for PVTG which are not availed now.
- Annapurna Cards for eligible who have not availed till now.
- Cast Certificates, Ration Cards to all eligible.
- To follow up all pending and rejected petitions filed in the grievances redressals meetings.
- Document land issues and work towards resolving them.
- Regular organized actions and representations along with intensifying the litigation measures in the effective implementation of RR packages.
- Prepare organizers and coordinators of ALERT and its' frontal organizations for launching the 1st phase of the Project, treating the ongoing project as pilot project.

7. Review of project concept and its applicability in the engage contexts.

The issues concerning Forest Rights Acts taken new directions due to the interventions of Supreme Court, which wants the rejected claimants to be evicted from their lands. This issue has to be addressed by the likeminded CSOs and Mass organizations and the Supreme Court which stayed its own order until now requires a lot of lobbying & advocacy with Forest Revenue and Tribal Welfare Departments.

The websites on ROFR, R&R and LTR are not updated and access restricted to key information which should have been kept in the public domain.

In the seven submergence mandals, land records have been tampered by the Revenue staff the custodian of revenue records and they work in unison, irrespective of their line of command and everyone benefit with tempering of land records, where the land acquisition and large scale encroachment of tribal lands by non tribals involved. Agency laws have not been effectively implemented especially in those seven sub mergence mandals, where ALERT intends to focus more.

ALERT is contemplating to introduce model PESA/self-governance in partnership with the mandal organizers, who will also coordinate the land issues of various forms of violations of rights besides monitoring the implementation of R&R packages.

The concept of community organizers working as volunteers who were paid food and travel expenses was dropped and fee for services at the rate Rs.10, 000/- per mandal organizer was paid from 28th February, 2021 in addition to the monthly travel expenses of Rs.2,000/- per month with an understanding that EPF and ESI to be introduced in the 1st phase of project.

8. Unintended Impact

There is hardly any NGO working on rights based interventions on ROFR and R&R issues in the project area. In this context, real need based interventions during the floods, sharing of relevant information with various adivasi groups and facilitating for the conduct of joint action committee meetings, created conducive/ enabling environment.

Good response to RTI applications, support role being played by Lokayuktha and Adivasi leaders of various out fits working with Adivasi Mahasabha has resulted in more visibility acceptance.

The government's commitment to issue ROFR title deeds as part of non-monitory measures helped in getting more ROFR title deeds in favor of advises.

The adivasi youth are more interested in availing of monetary benefits, despite of lot of violations with short sighted pecuniary benefits. As a result, interest in articulating their demands. The government employees try to manipulate with false promises and non-transparent means, where as any representations on such violations is seen as anti-social and instigation of innocent tribes.

In order to have focused interventions in the scheduled areas of West and East Godavari districts, the work undertaken with Yenadis was handed over to PPSS a local partner organization, which has been

working in partnership with NABARD, Tribal welfare department, Yenadis fishers and M.S.R.F, NABARD and MSRF have committed to support PPSS in promoting FPO of fishers in cage culture regeneration of mangroves etc.

9. Effects with regards to cross-cutting issues

The successful implementation of on-going RoFR and R&R packages ensures that, all women become co-owners of all RoFR & Assigned lands and houses in relocated colonies, which will contribute to their economic independence. Further, strengthening of women and Adivasis leaders on gender equality in implementing protective legislations that demand at least 50% women participate in gramasabha meetings, steering of community owned effective service delivery and joint owners of assets, mobility of women in non-traditional roles are given priority. Promoting women and disabled peoples friendly environment are being consciously nurtured in the project area as a cross cutting theme and in social inclusion policy.

10. Internal assessment

The findings of internal assessment were taken into consideration and documented in the project proposal of 1st phase.

11. Outcome, relevance and sustainability

The objectively verifiable indicators revealed that the target values that were set at the beginning of the project exceeded far beyond the expectations in two out of three indicators and in one indicator concerning the Re-habitation and Resettlement packages, due to the delay in the construction of Re-settlement colonies, the Re-habitation measures are getting delayed due to inadequate budget allocation by the Government of India, which is responsible for implementing the Polavaram National Irrigation Project. The details of achievements in the early part of this report.

12. Project approach

The target values set for two indicators have achieved for beyond expectations due to a feel conduct actions ALERT reaffirms that the chosen project approach was successful in achieving project objectives.

Invoking the provisions of RTI, collecting the secondary data and its validation as well as dissemination for follow up interventions in a campaign subsequent lobbying and advocacy interventions were important factors for achieving the project objective.

13. Contribution to the development goal

All activities, strategies, outputs, high level performance of target values, the development interventions that were taken up for strengthening of database, educating, mobilizing and organizing the Adivasis for addressing their issues under their own leadership clearly reveal that the project process, strategies and outcome of the project, that all intervention are contributing to the development goal of empowering Adivasis as the strategies involve all key line departments and NGOs working on forest rights.

14. Relevance of the Project

The Adivasis living in the scheduled areas are confronted with the issues of weak PRIs, CBOs, lack of information, in effective implementation of protective legislations which resulted in the defunct ML groups deprival from availing of fair & just compensation, non Fulfilment of Rehabilitation & Resettlement measures coupled with denial of forest rights to the eligible due to weak functional and non-accountable government line departments and in such a scenario the real need based interventions assumed all the more relevance and valid for reviving and steering the rights based interventions.

15. Sustainability

Humble beginning has been made for promoting and strengthening of CBOs of Adivasis under their own leadership with real need based plans for creating awareness on rights entitlements grievances redressals, promotion of local leadership, assets building and promoting sustainable livelihoods.

ALERT as the facilitating partner organization, will focus in creating everlasting impact and lay strong foundation in the empowerment process of Adivasis under their own leadership with appropriate linkages, networks and alliances.

16. Overall assessment, highlights, challenges, lessons learned, “good fit practices”, etc.

Highlights: The ongoing project is from August 2018 to February 2021 meant for empowering Adivasis with special focus on availing Forest Rights (FR) for at least 20,000 acres of land, monitoring the effective implementation of at least 6 out of 9 Re-habitation & Resettlement (R&R) packages of Polavaram project displaced & affected families and facilitating effective service delivery of Government (Govt.) line departments by successfully resolving at least 20,000 grievances.

Though the project period witnessed turbulent events, the national elections, change of govt in A.P, election to local bodies, Covid pandemic, annual occurrence of floods in the Polavaram submergence area etc. ALERT could achieve the envisaged outcome of the project and created an ever lasting impact in claiming FRs successfully, resolving contemporary issues on rights & entitlements and monitor the results of slowly progressing implementation of Rehabilitation and Resettlement(R&R) measures on account of Land Acquisition (LA) for Polavaram Irrigation (PI) and resultant displacement.

Challenges: Supported for availing Individual and Community Forest Resource title deeds for 103,397 acres in these and pursuing the rejected, pending and newly identified lands for claiming ROFR titles.

As on Feb-2021, 8458 ST families are relocated: In this 8232 received house sites and houses, under land for land out of 2370, only 2330 were given land for land, the annuity of Rs.5 Lakhs per family was given to 7940 out of 8458 families, subsistence grant of INR 1, 50,000 was paid to 7889 out of 8458 families, towards cattle shed, petty shop compensation out of 789 eligible only 599 families paid @Rs.25, 000/-. Similarly towards Artisans &traders all 48 eligible families were paid @Rs. 25000/-. Towards conferring fishing rights though there are 1411 are eligible none was conferred rights, towards value of trees & immovable assets out of 8458 families 8341 availed the compensation and finally the people who were shifted prior to 2013 whose compensation due for 814 members until now not received. Due to funding constraints, several families were not paid compensation and houses were also not completed and people though were asked and forced to move to plains unfinished R&R colonies the Adivasis were reluctant move until the compensation packages are paid and title deeds for forest rights are conferred for which they will also be eligible to get either money or compensation under land for land.

Two mass organizations namely Adivasi Maha Sabha (AMS) and Polavaram Project Nirvasithula Sadhana Samikhya (PPNSS) were registered under Societies Registration Act in 2020 having the life membership of 50 in each organization and taking up issues with the support of ALERT and it is envisaged to increase the life membership in those organizations with a minimum of 500 life members and in annual membership base during the next 3 years.

Lessons learned: Substantial evidence based, documentation, lobbying, advocacy, alliance building, including exploring of other choices like recourse to high court, statutory right bodies etc. either through like-minded groups and CBOs affected individuals should continue to be a priority in realizing envisaged results.

After weighing the pros and cons, ALERT wants to share the documents and make important information accessible at one source (website) and through social media so that people can have free access to the data. As part of open data policy, ALERT intends to educate and organize the target groups (primary stake holders) to demand public accountability for which mobilizing the people will result in quality participation for the cause of empowering the Adivasis under their own leadership which implies that AMS gains more visibility in Adivasi communities as their representative body and strengthening of local CBOs & PRIs.

Alert wants to ensure timely, qualitative corruption free, cost effective services are made available to all the primary stake holders. To be relevant, it is necessary to keep updating of records on a regular basis along with quality resource materials for creating an enabling environment, mobilizing and organizing people to avail their rights entitlements, pursuing for realizing their unfulfilled concerns, while ensuring affirmative actions in a mission mode for which more human and material resources may have to be mobilized

Comprehensive data mining on R&R, RoFR, pending grievances at various levels and other relevant areas that are needed for present and future interventions with appropriate dependable data base will help the Adivasi communities, NGOs, Researchers, CSOs and govt. line departments in furthering objective of empowering Adivasis in the scheduled areas.

The staffing pattern of ALERT associated with the large target area and the envisaged results have to undergo minor changes at organizers level and geo graphical limits.

It is proposed to classify the area of operation of ALERT into intensive, semi intensive and limited area of interventions for ensuring effective results management and service delivery on major issues in the submergence mandals including LTR violations to be documented and followed up consistently with documentary evidence for getting tangible results especially in the context of adhoc functioning of bureaucracy in Adivasi areas.

Limited area of operation for experimenting the concept of governance as part of Adivasi Legal Resource Centre (ALRC) in scheduled areas may have to be considered in due course.

Most of the reasons mentioned for rejections of the claims for IFR, CFRs and CFRRs are violations of Affirmative Legislations governing the Scheduled areas are volative of the provisions of Forest Right Act. Yet the Tribal Welfare Department, the Nodal agency did not take up the issues and address these gaps that are documented and taken up which have be pursued in a consistent manner.

The lands for which title deeds were issued, those deeds that were not recorded in the Record of Rights (ROR), Giri Bhoomi website were not considered to get government schemes or bank loans in the scheduled area. In effective implementation of key provisions of LARR Act to be regularly monitored and addressed through peer pressure and legal interventions.

The mass organizations promoted by ALERT are expected to enroll at least 5 members in each habitation (elected representatives, caste/community leaders, educated youth, chairpersons of FRCs', President of women of organization in villages etc.) who are getting connected through whats'app, sms messaging, you tube and other appropriate forms of print, electronic, audio and videos which will strengthen JACs and PPNSS, other CBOs and CSOs working with Adivasis, environment and with socially excluded groups, in the at least 1000 of them have to be enrolled as the life members of AMS to make these organizations true representative bodies of Adivasis in the target area of operation. For scaling up of interventions and to be proud co-owners of process, the mass organizations and their allied CBOs' to be made to feel that they are part of their development process.

Pursuing of pending court cases, pursuing grievances that are pending at various levels and lobbying to have access to the either to restricted public websites, which are meant for promoting transparency and accountability are some of the measures to be put into practice, besides mobilizing resources under prescribed fee for services at appropriate time. The Adivasis get cheated by the vested interests, viz touts, politicians and greedy officials. The Adivasis are looking for immediate gains even if small and don't have

patience and belief in the existing system that it would render justice. They should be motivated to work for tangible results, which is a challenging task to be meticulously addressed.